



MARKETING LABS · STRATEGY & GROWTH

Lean Analytics Stages

Measure the question that matters right now.

Interactive Lean Analytics Stages canvas for Empathy, Stickiness, Virality, Revenue and Scale.

Includes: framework reference · guidance by Lean Analytics stage · printable worksheet

Lean Analytics Stages: reference

INTERACTIVE STARTUP-METRICS PROTOTYPE

Lean Analytics helps teams progress from a problem hypothesis to a scalable business by focusing on one core uncertainty at a time: customer need, retention, organic growth, sustainable revenue and efficient scale. Use each stage to define an experiment, select practical evidence and decide what must be true before moving forward.

Do not treat the stages as a universal, rigid sequence. A product may need to revisit earlier assumptions, and not every business relies on virality. The useful principle is to resolve the most consequential uncertainty before spending heavily on the next growth lever.

Lean Analytics journey

Select a stage to inspect its central question, evidence, current experiment and gate to progress.

Current learning focus

Learning-plan coverage

5 of 5 stages planned

CURRENT EXPERIMENT

DECISION THRESHOLD

NEXT MOVE

Experiment discipline

- ? Start with a decision, not a dashboard: state what uncertainty this metric is meant to reduce.
- ? Use a small, credible experiment before committing large budgets, extensive build effort or irreversible choices.
- ? Pair quantitative signals with qualitative observation—numbers can tell you what happened, but not always why.
- ? Avoid vanity metrics that look impressive but do not change a product, customer or investment decision.
- ? Set a threshold in advance, including what you will do if the evidence is weaker, mixed or stronger than expected.
- ? Respect privacy and consent: collect only data you need, explain its use and avoid manipulative growth tactics.

Guidance by Lean Analytics stage

1. Empathy — problem and customer understanding

Empathy experiment: Conduct semi-structured problem interviews with research-development staff and principal investigators; use a simple interactive prototype to test whether the proposed workflow is understand...

Decision rule: At least 12 of 15 relevant interviewees describe a recurring problem and agree to test a prototype

If supported: Build a narrow MVP focused on stakeholder mapping, pathway design and collaborative export, then test whether early users return to complete a second planning task.

2. Stickiness — engagement and retention

Stickiness experiment: Run a six-week pilot with a small cohort; track activation, repeated use, completed maps, collaboration invitations and qualitative reasons for return or drop-off.

Decision rule: At least 40% of activated pilot users return in week 4 and complete a second meaningful planning action

If supported: Refine onboarding and the core planning workflow around the repeated value moment before investing materially in broader acquisition.

3. Virality — repeatable growth loops

Virality experiment: Test contextual collaboration prompts, shareable read-only outputs and team templates with pilot users; compare invitation behaviour and invited-user activation.

Decision rule: At least 25% of activated workspaces invite a collaborator, and at least half of invited collaborators activate

If supported: Develop the strongest collaboration loop and test it with a narrow acquisition channel before increasing promotion spend.

4. Revenue — monetisation and unit economics

Revenue experiment: Offer a paid team plan with clear value tiers after the pilot; conduct structured pricing conversations and track conversion, objections and use by role.

Decision rule: At least 30% of eligible pilot organisations convert to a paid plan at a price that supports a viable gross margin

If supported: Confirm pricing, package boundaries and sales motion, then test acquisition-payback assumptions with a small repeatable pipeline.

5. Scale — efficient repeatable growth

Scale experiment: Expand through a limited set of university partnerships and track performance by institution, segment, channel, onboarding model and support requirement.

Decision rule: New cohorts retain at comparable levels, payback remains within the agreed period and support demand stays within planned capacity

If supported: Scale only the channels, segments and operational systems that preserve customer value and unit economics.

Lean Analytics Stages: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Venture, product or experiment

For example: A new SaaS product, marketplace or service

Lean Analytics stage

- ☐ 1. Empathy — problem and customer understanding ☐ 2. Stickiness — engagement and retention
- ☐ 3. Virality — repeatable growth loops ☐ 4. Revenue — monetisation and unit economics
- ☐ 5. Scale — efficient repeatable growth

Current hypothesis or question

What do you believe, and what uncertainty are you trying to reduce?

One metric that matters

For example: Week-4 retention or trial-to-paid conversion

Decision threshold

What result would justify progress, iteration or stopping?

Experiment or evidence-gathering activity

Describe the smallest credible test you will run.

Next action if the threshold is met

State the next decision or experiment—not a vague ambition.

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.